Bukhari Chancery Persian Textbook Development

participles_dagi

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Grammatical Explanation

The 'participle-ization' of Central Asian Persian stands among the features that most distinguish it from classical and modern Iranian Persian. It is also — not coincidentally — the grammatical logic that makes Central Asian Persian most similar to Turkic languages.

Modern Iranian Persian and standard Tajik form relative clauses with a relative particle, much as English does: که works like 'that' or 'which'. For instance: 'The student read the book that his teacher had given him' (донишҷӯ китоберо хонд ки устодаш ба ӯ дода буд / دانشجو کتابی را خواند که استادش به او داده بود).

The same idea could be expressed in Central Asian Persian (which retains the relative particle که as well) as follows: شاگرد کتابِ استادش داده گی را خواند: *lit.* 'The student read the given-[to him]-by-his-teacher book', or, in more natural English, 'The student read the book given [to him] by his teacher'. (The vocabulary differs slightly between these sentences, and in the Turkic versions below, because each uses the word for 'student' or 'teacher' most natural to that language or register: this has no bearing on the grammar.) The key word is built from the past participle of the verb (داده, 'given') and the suffix گی (-gī). To

distinguish it from other Persian participle forms, this book refers to the result the -gi participle.

Grammatically, استادش داده گی is functioning as an adjective modifying کتاب, just like the participle 'given' in English, and following logic more typical of Turkic languages. The participle can follow the noun, joined to it by the iżāfa like any other Persian adjective (kitāb-i ustādash dāda-gī), or it can precede the noun with no iżāfa, as in Turkic languages. Both orders are frequent in the documents. The doer of the action can stand before the participle, as here, or after it (firistāda-gī-yi nāyib, 'sent by the deputy'), or it can be marked by a possessive ending on the participle (داده گی اش, 'that he gave').

Note that the relative marker (nishāna-i mawṣūlī, the ی) used in the که construction is not used with the -gi participle: کتابی که, but کتابِ داده گی. Note also that the indirect object was explicit in the modern Tajik / Iranian Persian example ('to him', i.e., the student) but is only implied in this sentence — an ambiguity typical of both Turkic and Bukhari chancery Persian.

Bukharan scribes usually write the participle in full before (دادهگی) گی, whereas standard Persian orthography drops the ه in comparable words (زندگی, not زنده گی). This is a difference of spelling convention only: the pronunciation is the same either way (Tajik simply writes додагӣ), and a manuscript cannot show whether the scribe thought of the form as one word or two. The scribes' practice is not completely uniform, quite possibly because the form is specific to Central Asia: they knew the word well, but there was no formal orthography for it. The future intentional (chapter [[]]) is likewise written in more than one way.

The participle can also take the prefix می to describe action that is ongoing, habitual, or intended: میآمده گی, 'that come' or 'that are coming'. It can likewise stand on its own as a noun: گفته گی, 'what was said'. Both uses appear in the examples below.

Modern Iranian Persian does use participles as adjectives (کتابِ چاپشده, 'the printed book'), but it does not normally allow such a participle a subject of its own, as in استادش داده گی.

In Central Asian Turki, by contrast, this is the ordinary way of forming a relative clause, and there is no relative particle like که. A suffix turns the verb into an adjective, and the whole phrase stands before the noun it modifies. For completed action the suffix is Uzbek -gan, Uyghur غان / گەن: kelgan odam / كەلگەن ئادەم, 'the person who came'. For action that is ongoing, habitual, or intended it is Uzbek -adigan, Uyghur يدىغان: keladigan odam / كېلىدىغان ئادەم, 'the person who comes' or 'who will come'. The two correspond to the Persian forms without and with می. The subject of the participle simply stands before it, so that the model sentence above would be rendered in Uzbek as talaba o'qituvchisi bergan kitobni o'qidi and in Uyghur as ئوقۇغۇچى ئوقۇتقۇچىسى بەرگەن كىتابنى ئوقۇدى. Like its Persian counterpart, the Turki participle can also stand on its own as a noun: Uzbek kelganlar, 'those who came'.

When the participle is that of the verb 'to be' (بوده گی, 'which is [in a place]'), Uzbek normally renders it not with -gan but with its suffix -dagi, which attaches to nouns (Buxorodagi, 'located in Bukhara'). The first example below shows both.

The construction is not confined to Bukhari chancery Persian: it remains in use in spoken Tajik. For instance: Фарзанд ба пули падараш додагӣ либос харид (Uzbek: Farzand otasi bergan pulga kiyim sotib oldi), 'The child bought clothes with the money his father had given'.

Examples

> bukh: **سخن های من** ویدین اسکی سهواً **در مابین ما بوده گی** لاکن احتمالدارد که ترجمان بشما بر غلط ترجمه کرده باشد **گفته گی**

> uzb: Lekin **oramizdagi** tarjimon Vidinskiy **men aytgan** so'zlarni sizga sahvan noto'g'ri tarjima qilgan bo'lishi mumkin.

fars: سهواً **که من گفتم** سخنانی را ، **که میان ما بود** اما احتمال دارد ویدینسکی، مترجمی برای شما نادرست ترجمه کرده باشد

eng: But it is possible that Vidinsky, the interpreter **who was between us** , mistakenly mistranslated to you the words **that I said** .

Comments:

sukhan-hā-yi man gufta-gī ('the words that I said') is the pattern introduced in the explanation: the noun, the iżāfa, the participle's own subject (man, 'I'), and the participle.

dar mā-bayn-i mā būda-gī ('who was between us') uses the participle of 'to be' to say where someone is. Uzbek renders this one with its own suffix -dagi (oramizdagi) and the other with -gan (men aytgan), so that one sentence shows both Uzbek counterparts.

The sentence comes from a letter of the Bukharan government to the representative of the Soviet Republic, written in February 1920.

> bukh: نایب ایلچی بجنابعالیحضرتم منظورِ نظرِ انورِ هماوین عالی **فرستاده گی** ترتیب نامه موالیم شود

> uzb: Elchining o'rinbosari tomonidan **yuborilgan** (ko'rsatmalar) hujjat Amir hazratga ma'qul bo'ladi, deb o'ylayman.

> fars: نایب ایلچی آن را به جناب عالی حضرت **که** این ترتیب نامه ای است تا **فرستاده است** از نظر مبارک او بگذرد

> eng: Let the instructional memo, **which was sent** by the assistant to the Political Agent, grace the radiant eyes of His Majesty (the Amir)

Comments:

> The participle in this example is both preceded and followed by an iżāfa genitive connector (which is not marked in the original script): tartīb-nāma-i firistāda-gī-yi nāyib.

> elchi (ایلچی) is a Turki word for 'ambassador,' but always refers to the Russian Political Agent in this context.

Readers of early modern documents must become accustomed to lofty euphemisms and honorifics. In this example, the language revolves around the royal gaze of the amir: the memo referenced at the beginning of the original sentence is 'seen' (manẓūr, using an Arabic passive participle) by the radiant ('anwar'), 'august' (humāyūn) 'gaze' (naẓar, from the same Arabic root as the participle).

Iranian Persian has euphemism similar in meaning, which appears in the translation: از نظر مبارک او بگذرد, 'to pass [before] his [referring to the sovereign] auspicious gaze'.

The question of document type and hierarchy in Perso-Islamic cultures of documentation is a challenging one, and it becomes even more so in the quasi-colonial context in which most Bukharan documents were written. This is partly because Perso-Islamic document types often imply a hierarchy (e.g., a farmān was a royal order from a superior to inferior, whereas an ʿarża was a 'petition' from an inferior to superior): the Russian conquest distorted those hierarchies, and rendered them more ambiguous. Tartīb-nāma (lit. 'arrangement letter') seems to have been a novel document type referring to official instructions circulated by Bukharan officials at the 'request' of the Russian Political Agent.

bukh: سیوم **حکومت روسیه در عهد ایمپراطوری زور القبض خود در اورده گی** شهر ها را چنانچه سمرقند و دیزخ و کته قورغان را مع تابعاتش …

uzb: Uchinchidan, **Rossiya hukumati imperiya davrida kuch bilan qo'lga kiritgan** shaharlarni, chunonchi Samarqand, Jizzax va Kattaqo'rg'onni tobe' yerlari bilan birga …

fars: سوم، شهرهایی را **که حکومت روسیه در دوران امپراتوری به زور به تصرف خود درآورده است** ، مانند سمرقند و جیزخ و کتهقورغان با توابعشان …

eng: Third: the cities **that the Russian government brought under its control by force in the imperial era** , such as Samarkand, Jizzakh and Katta-Qurghan with their dependencies …

Comments:

The whole participial clause, with its own subject (ḥukūmat-i Rūsīya, 'the Russian government'), stands before the noun it modifies (شهر ها) with no iżāfa, exactly as in the Uzbek. Compare the first example, where the participle follows its noun.

> The sentence comes from a letter of Amir ʿĀlim Khān to the Versailles peace conference, requesting recognition of Bukhara's independence.

> bukh: رعیه روسیه عبد مؤمن **استقامت داشته گی** در قیشلاق سرای حدثه واقع شده در آنجاه ولد محمد حسین را بقتل رسانیداند

> uzb: Qishloq joyida bir voqea sodir bo'lib, u yerda **yashaydigan** Rossiya (imperiyasi) fuqarosi Abdimo'min Muhammad Husayn o'g'lini o'ldirishdi.

> fars: در "قشلاق سرای" حادثه ای رخ داده است. عبد مؤمن ولد محمد حسین را که تبعه روسیه بوده و **که در آنجا اقامت داشته** به قتل رسانده اند

> eng: In the village estate an incident occurred: a Russian subject, Abd al-Mumin ibn Muhammad Husayn, **who resided there,** was murdered.

Comments:

> Note the use of the gerund واقع شده ('taking place'): as discussed in chapter [[]]: this style is acceptable in Iranian

> Persian, but more favored in Turkic languages (-ib) to break up parts of the sentence, which would usually be expressed with a conjunction (و) in classical Persian or a sentence break in modern Persian.

> raʿīya, alongside fuqarāʾ (which evolved to mean 'citizen' in the singular in modern Uzbek and Uyghur), is a ubiquitous term meaning 'subject' (and equivalent to the imperial category подданный / poddannyi in Russian). This example makes it clear that Abd al-Mumin was a Russian subject, though almost certainly not ethnically Russian. The term for subjecthood used in the Qajar context (تابع) was rarely, if ever, used with this specific legal meaning in Central Asia.

> In this context, qishlāq-sarāy is most likely a generic term referring to a village estate rather than a proper noun.

> Here the participial phrase (در آنجاه استقامت داشته گی) comes before the noun it modifies (رعیه روسیه) and there is no iżāfa between them: the Turkic order.

> bukh: تماماً نداده اند **بتاراج برده گی اشانرا** باوجود آن اموالهای

uzb: Shunga qaramay, **talon-toroj qilib olib ketgan** mollarini to'liq qaytarib bermaganlar.

fars: با وجود این، اموالی را **که به تاراج برده بودند** به‌تمامی پس نداده‌اند

eng: Even so, they have not returned all the property **that they plundered** .

Comments:

The possessive ending attached to the participle (برده گی اشان) marks its subject: 'that they carried off'. The ending says only 'they'; who is meant has to be found from the context.

Spoken Tajik does the same: ҷӯраам ба ҷойи гуфтагӣам омад, 'my friend came to the place that I mentioned'.

bukh: توابعات **میبرامده گی** بمکتوب از وجه محافظت کردن بعضی نشانگاه اسباب قدیمئ بخارای شریف اعلام نموده اند

uzb: Maktub orqali Buxoroyi Sharifga tobe' hududlardan **chiqadigan** qadimiy arxeologik ashyolardan nishona ba'zi joylarni muhofazat qilishlarini ma'lum qilganlar.

fars: از آنها اشیاء قدیمی **که** از طریق این نوشته، محافظت از بناهای توابع بخارای شریف را اعلام کرده اند **استخراج شده است**

eng: This letter has informed (us) of preservation of the ruins, **which have been discovered** outside of Bukhara.

Comments:

Note that adjectives (and therefore participles) precede the modified noun in Turkic languages, but come after the noun in Persian. In this example, an izofa construction connects اسبابِ قدیمیٔ to میبرامده گی

The verb برآمدن is the standard verb for 'to leave,' 'to exit' in modern Tajik as well (баромадан), but not used in Iranian Persian.

asbāb - which means 'reasons' in Arabic - may seem a curious word to refer broadly to objects (in this case, material remains). However, this usage is common to South Asia as well.

> The Uzbek rendering uses -adigan (chiqadigan) and not -gan, matching the می of the Persian participle.

> bukh: از وجه صلات های **از تورت کول بچهار** و **از چهار جوی بتورت کول میرفته گی** فرمان بیک میرزا باشی را تعین کرده فرستاده **جوی میآمده گی** …

> uzb: **Chorjo'ydan To'rtko'lga boradigan** va **To'rtko'ldan Chorjo'yga keladigan** soldatlar xususida Farmonbek mirzaboshini tayinlab yuborib …

> fars: درباره سربازانی **از تورتکول به چهارجوی** و **که از چهارجوی به تورتکول می‌روند** فرمان‌بیک میرزاباشی را تعیین کرده و فرستاده ، **می‌آیند** …

> eng: Concerning the soldiers **who are to go from Charjuy to Turtkul** and **to come from Turtkul to Charjuy** , having appointed and sent Farman Bek Mirza-bashi …

Comments:

> The two می participles describe a movement that is planned and has not yet taken place: 'the soldiers who are to go …

> and to come'. Uzbek -adigan covers the same range (boradigan, keladigan).

> Both participial phrases follow the noun they modify.

bukh: عرضه های تاتار ها بتوغریگی مایانرا حکومت بخارا بوقت شهر در آمدن اما دستگیر دروغ بوده جماعهٔ مذکور بعرض فاسد اینطریقه عرض را **گفته گی** نموده حبس میکرده اند کرده اند

uzb: Tatarlarning da'wosiga ko'ra, haqiqatda Buxoro hukumati shaharga kirishda bizlarni shaharga kiraverishda ushlab qamab qo'ymoqda, **deganlari** yolg'on bo'lib, mazkur jamoa xato ariza bergan ekan.

fars: ما را حکومکت بخارا هنگام ورودمان به شهر» **که گفته اند** ،شکایتنامهٔ تاتارها دستگیر و حبس می‌کرده است،» دروغ بوده است. گروه مورد اشاره با بیانی نادرست چنین شکایتی را نوشته‌اند

eng: The Tatars' **stated claim (which they submitted** as a petition), that actually the government of Bukhara arrested them when they entered the city, is a lie. The aforementioned group submitted an improper petition.

Comments:

> This Central Asian Persian example features the direct adoption of a Turki loan word: to'g'ri. The basic meaning of the word is 'correct' or 'straight' (similar to راست in Persian). Adopted into Persian in this example, بتوغریگی means 'actually' or 'in fact,' similar to در واقع in Farsi.

> This sentence features quoted speech, i.e., the claim that "we" were detained is designated as direct speech by گفته گی / degan. This is confusing because the first instance of the first person plural (مایانرا) refers to the Bukharan government officials investigating the claim, whereas the second instance (در آمدن اما) refers to the Tatars making the false claim.

> In both modern Farsi and Tajik, the extra alif in در آمدن اما is superfluous and would be در آمدن ما, but is a common convention in document writing — perhaps simply for readability.

References

- Chaghatay: Schluessel (58-60).
- Uyghur: De Jong (ch. XVII) treats these constructions as "verbal adjectives."

- Farsi: Perry (398-407) offers a detailed discussion of the relative particle kih (i.e., as used in modern Iranian Persian and Tajik)
- Central Asian Persian: Perry, 411-413 also offers a briefer discussion of the nominalized participles typical of Bukharan chancery Persian.